

L 1 Talking Head

- I'm Dr Jonathan Salo, a GI Cancer Surgeon at the in Charlotte, North Carolina If you're seeing this video, changes are you or someone close to you has had an encounter with esophageal cancer. These videos are designed to educate you about cancer and its treatment and help you and you cancer care team make the right decisions for you.
- Of course, there is no substitute for the expert opinions of your cancer care team.

I'm Dr Jonathan Salo, a GI Cancer Surgeon in Charlotte, North Carolina.

These videos are designed to help you and your family make the right decisions about your cancer care.

While I am a surgeon, I'm not *your* surgeon. There is of course no substitute for the advice of the cancer care team that knows you.

Gastrostomy Tube

The topic for this video is a feeding gastrostomy

Feeding Tube

- Formula

A gastrostomy tube can be used to administer formula

Feeding Tube

- Formula
- Water

Water

Feeding Tube

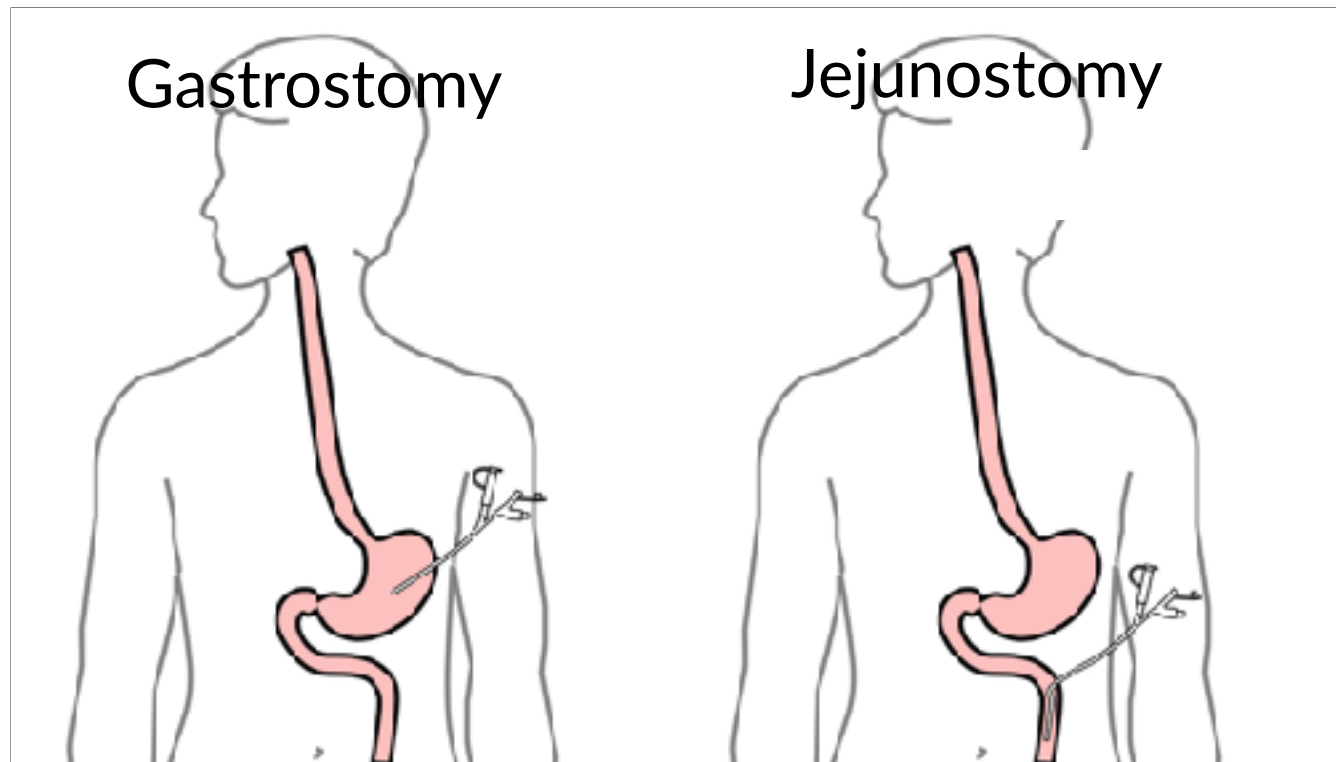
- Formula
- Water
- Medicines

And medicines

Feeding Tube

Does not interfere with eating and drinking by mouth

In most cases, a feeding tube will not interfere with eating by mouth



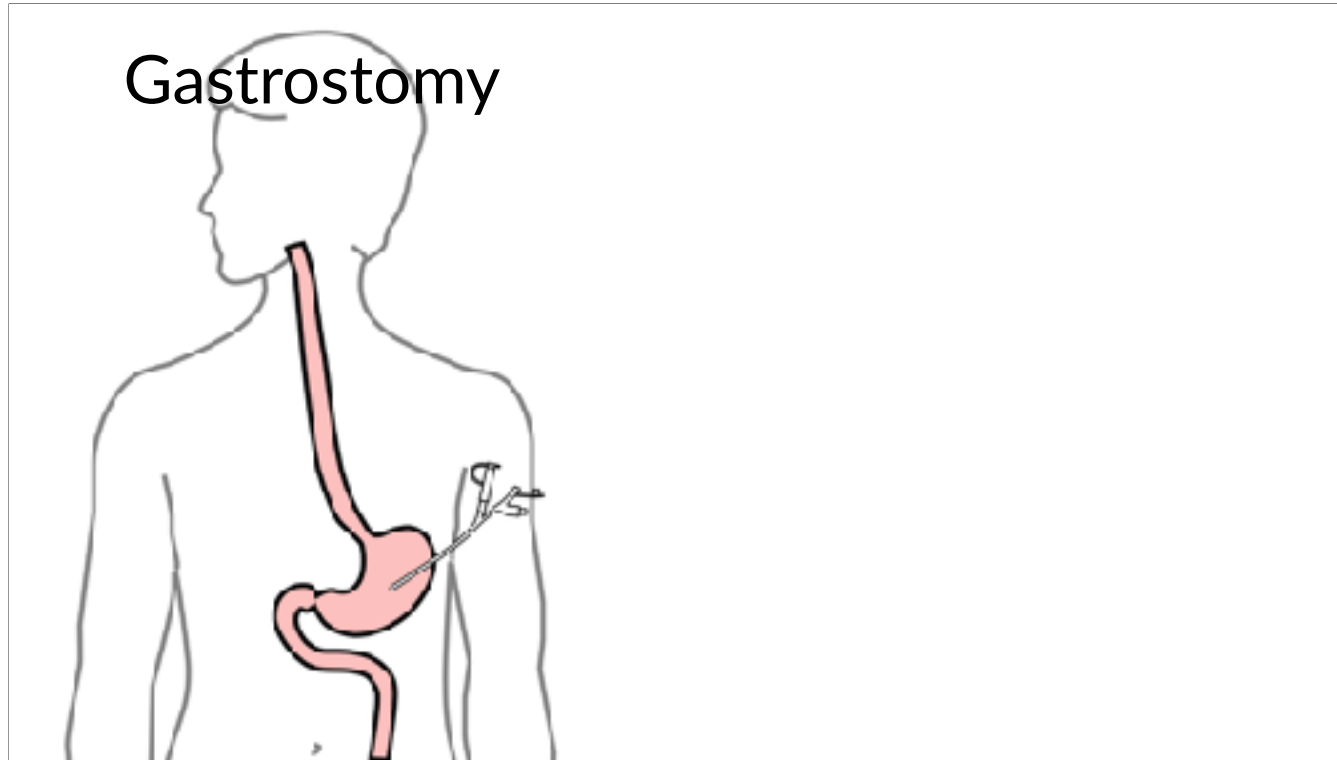
There are two different type of feeding tubes:

A Gastrostomy tube is placed into the stomach. Feeding can be done with a syringe

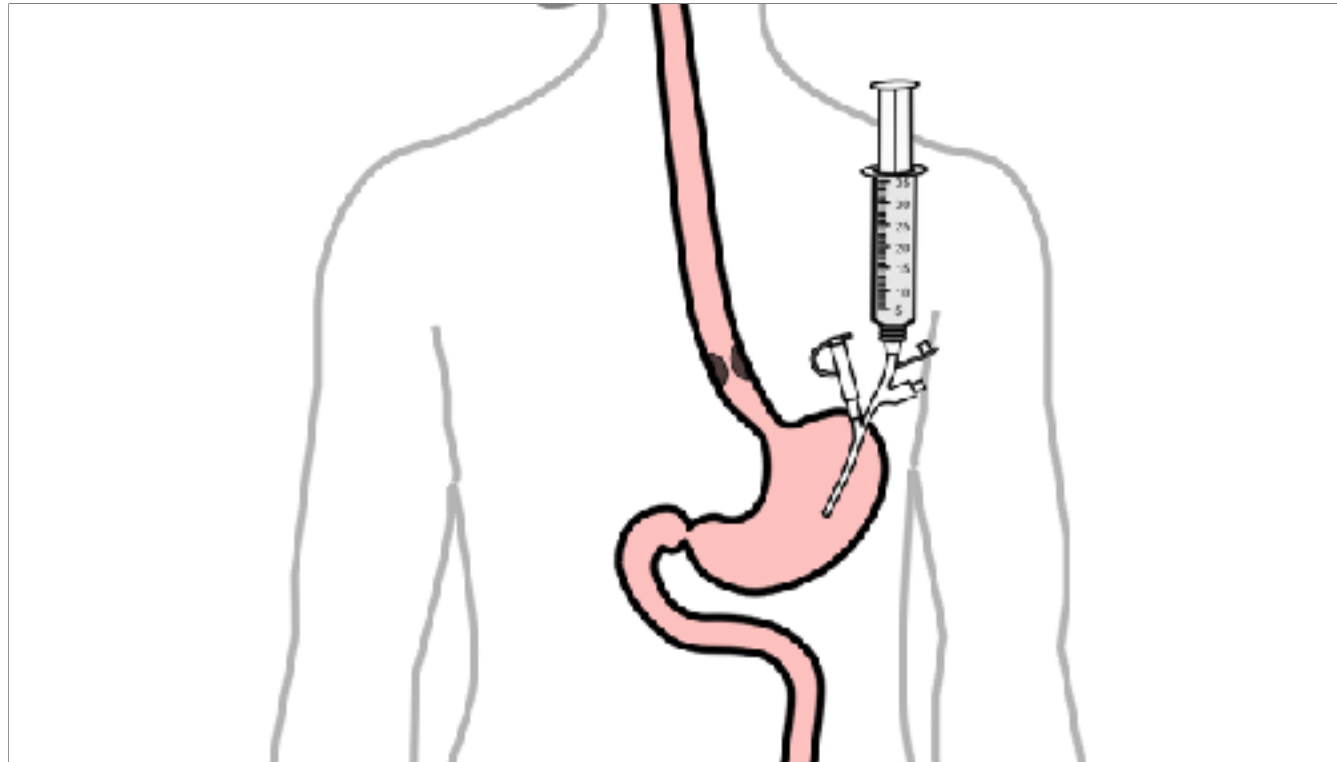
A Jejunostomy tube is placed into the small intestine called the jejunum. Feeding require a pump

We have a companion video about feeding jejunostomy tubes

Gastrostomy



The topic of this video is a gastrostomy tube, which is placed into the stomach



Feeding are typically done with a syringe



Here's what a tube may look like

Gastrostomy Tube

- Formula
- Water
- Medicines

A gastrostomy tube can be used to administer

Formula

Water

And Medicines

Administer Formula + Water

Syringe with Plunger

One method to administer formula or water is to use a syringe with a plunger



Here is a feeding tube syringe with a special spiral fitting at the end



The feedings can be simply administered slowly with a syringe.

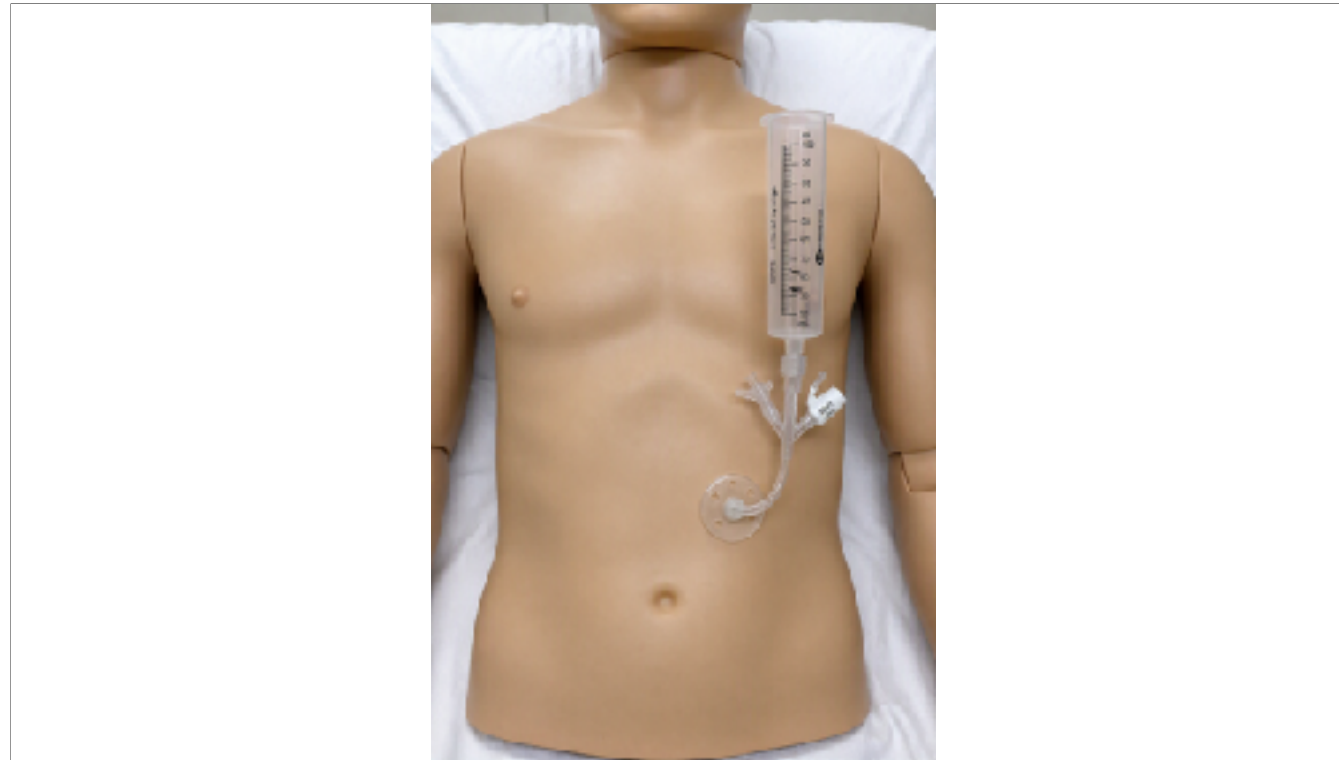
Administer Formula + Water

Syringe with Plunger
“Funnel” Technique without plunger

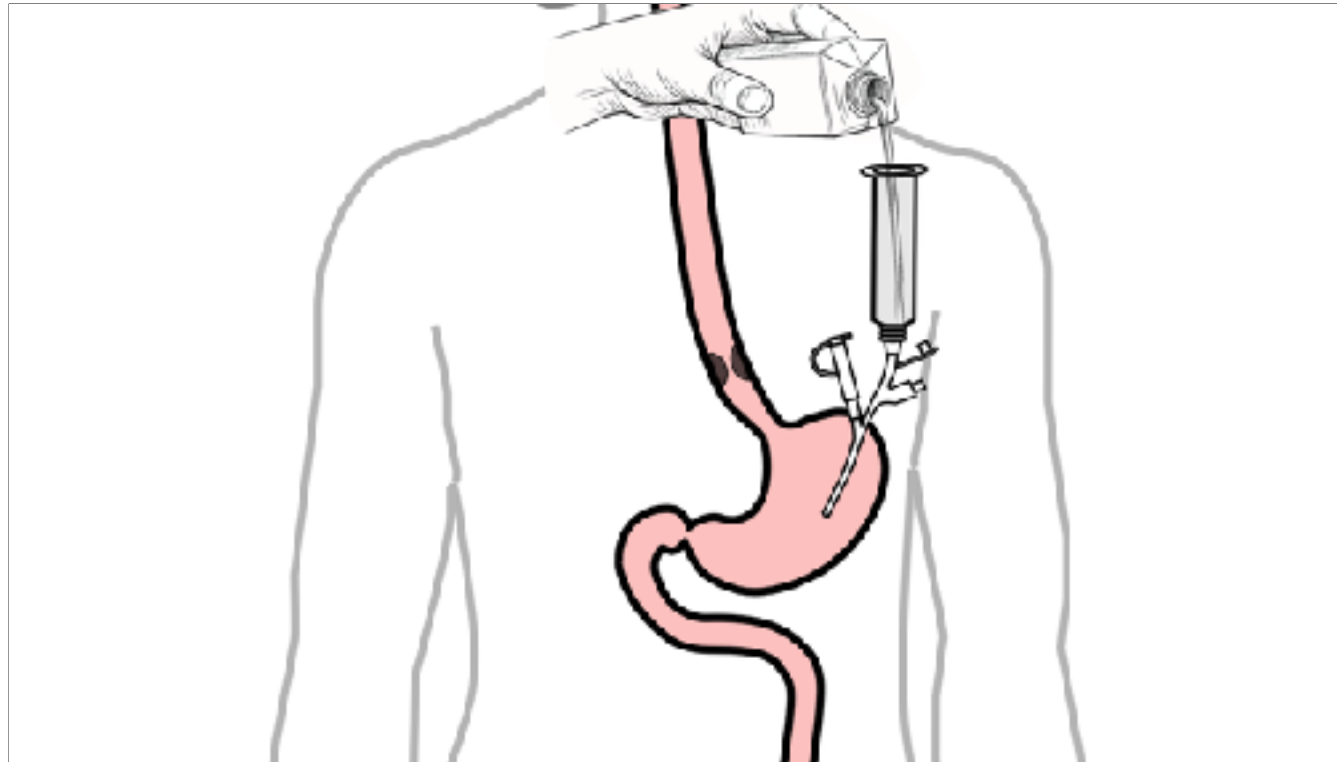
Another technique is to use the remove the plunger from the syringe to create a “funnel”



The plunger is removed from the syringe, leaving just the syringe barrel...



... which is connected to the feeding tube



Water or formula can then be poured into the barrel of the syringe like a funnel

How Much Formula Do I Need?

A common question is “How much formula do I need?”



Your dietitian will calculate your needs, but this can be between 4 and 6 cartons of formula per day. Cartons are frequently 8oz (240mL) each.

Administer Medicines

Liquid Medicines

A few medicines are available in liquid form



An example is the pain reliever Acetaminophen, also known by the brand name of Tylenol

Administer Medicines

Liquid Medicines

Crush pills and Resuspend in water

Some pills can be crushed and resuspended in water

Medicines which can't be crushed

Extended Release	XR	XL	XT
Sustained Release	ER	SR	LA
Controlled Release	CR	CD	

A word of caution, however, as some pills can't be crushed:

Extended release,
Sustained release, or
Controlled release

Medicines which can't be crushed

Extended Release
Sustained Release
Controlled Release

Tamsulosin (Flomax)
Liquid-filled capsules
Soft-gel capsules

In addition, Flomax, or tamsulosin, can't be given via a tube.

The same with liquid-filled capsules and soft-gel capsules.

Your pharmacist can help choose which pills can be safely crushed

Medicine Administration

Crush pills to powder → Dissolve in 60ml water

Many medicines, however, can be crushed and resuspended in water.



You place a pill inside the chamber of a pill crusher



Screw the cap on and twist the cap back and forth to crush the tablet inside the chamber



You now have a fine powder

Medicine Administration

Crush pills to powder → Dissolve in 60ml water

...and you can dissolve the power in water, typically 60mL



The water is introduced into the chamber, and once the powder is dissolved,



the liquid is drawn up into the syringe.

Medicine Administration

Crush pills to powder → Dissolve in 60ml water
Inject medicine into feeding tube

The medicine can then be injected into the feeding tube

Medicine Administration

Crush pills to powder → Dissolve in water

Inject medicine into feeding tube

Flush tube with additional water

It is important to flush the tube with additional water after administering the medicine

Medicine Administration

Don't mix medicines together

It's also important to administer the medicines separately, and not mix the medicines together

Medicine Administration

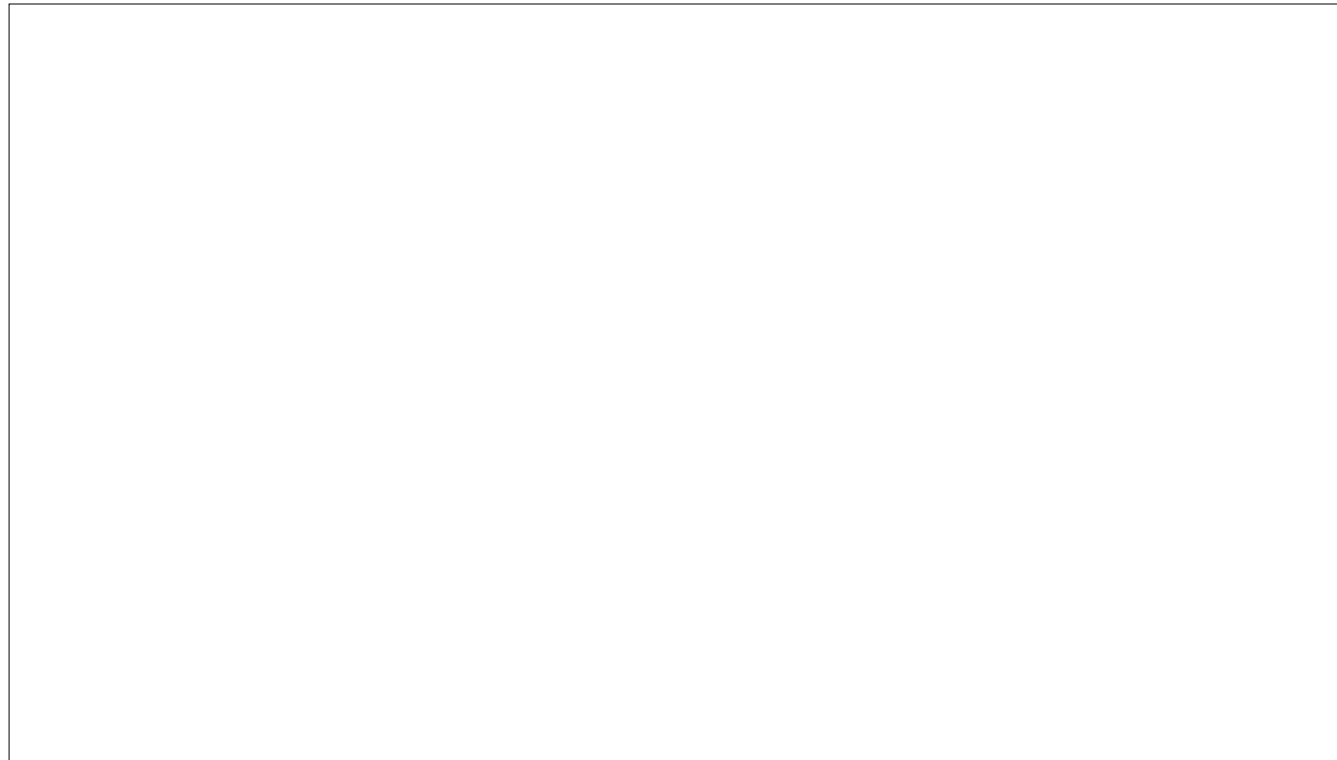
Don't mix medicines together
Flush tube between medicines

It is also important to flush the tube between medicines

Medicine Administration

Don't mix medicines together
Flush tube between medicines
Check with your pharmacist

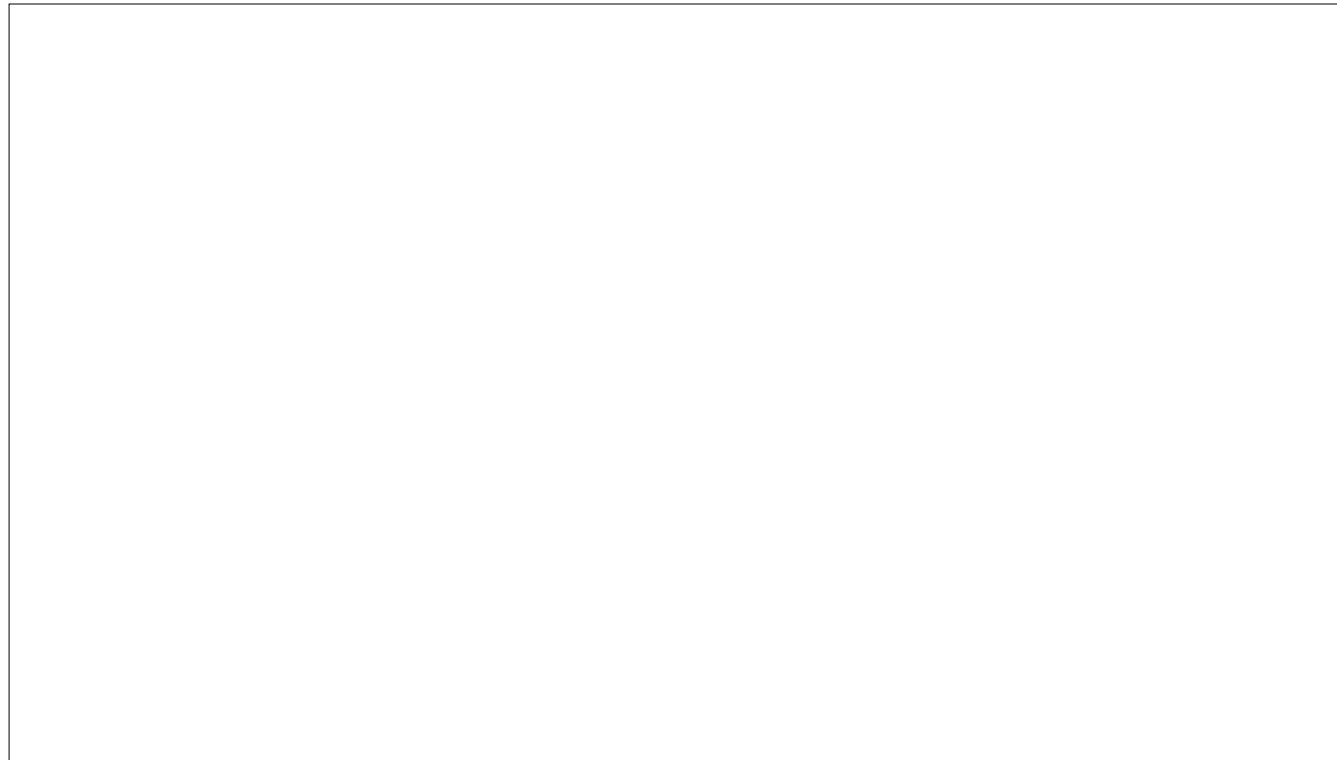
Your pharmacist can help by making certain that the medicines you are taking are suitable to be crushed and given through a feeding tube.



We hope you have found this video helpful. We have a companion video which describes a feeding jejunostomy.

Please leave a comment if you have topics you would like covered in videos.

Feel free to subscribe to be notified of new videos as we make them.



Our friend Brad has a gastrostomy tube, and we will demonstrate how to administer water or formula

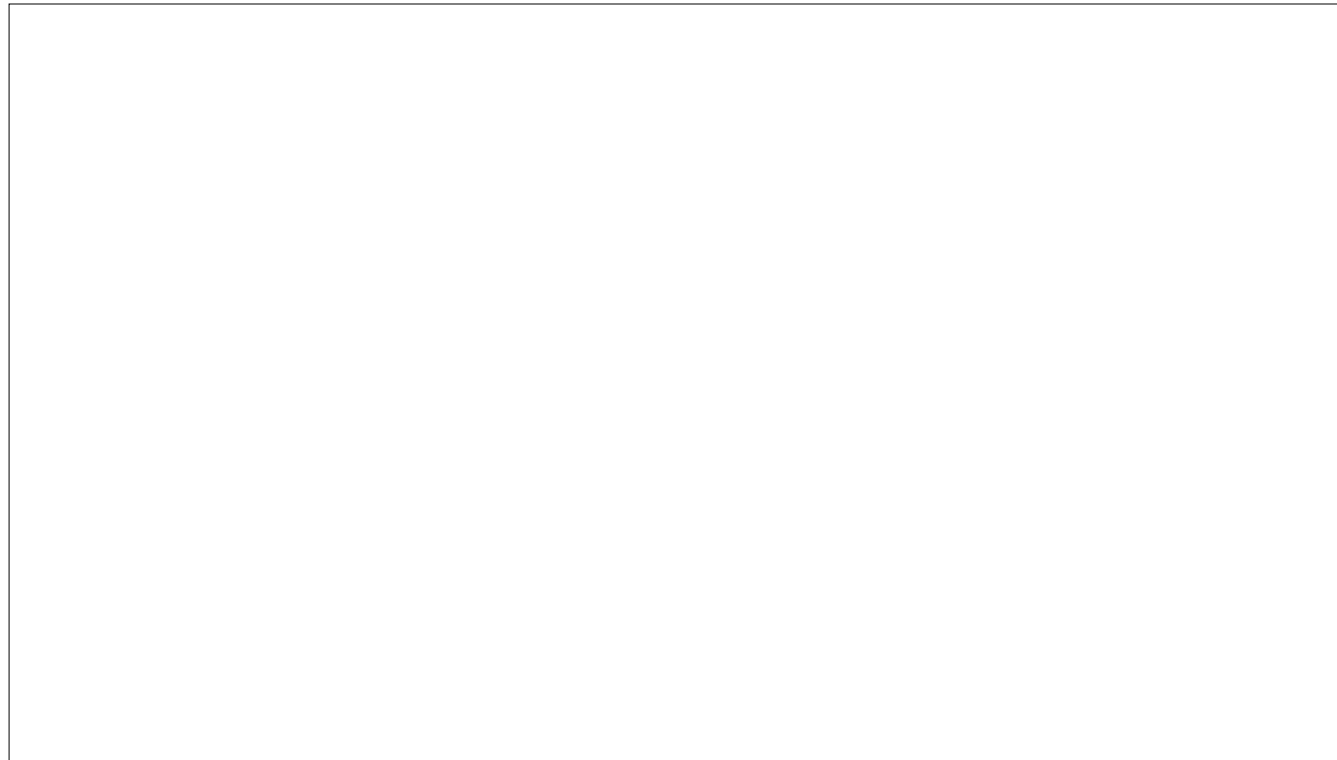
Open the cap

Attach the syringe to the tube by twisting it on

Empty the syringe

Remove the syringe by twisting

Close the cap



To use the funnel method, first remove the plunger from the barrel of the syringe

Open the cap

Attach the syringe to the tube by twisting it on

The water or formula is simply poured into the syringe barrel and gravity will take it into the stomach

Remove the syringe by twisting

Close the cap